

## Beppu Hot Springs

**Location** Kyushu island, Japan

Beppu has almost 3,000 geothermal springs, in eight major groups, the second-highest concentration in the world. The springs supply water at

temperatures up to 210°F (99°C) for bathing pools (*onsen*). The pool water is a range of different colors, depending on the mineral content. For example, Umi-Jigoku *onsen* is cobalt-blue, while Chinoike-Jigoku is blood-red. The heat source for the geothermal activity is the nearby Tsurumi lava dome.

## Mount Unzen

**Location** Kyushu island, Japan

This volcano complex was responsible for Japan's worst volcanic disaster when, in 1792, the collapse of one of its lava domes triggered a huge tsunami that killed about 15,000 people. Its most recent period of activity was 1990–96, when one eruption generated a pyroclastic flow (a rapid surge of hot gas and lava) that killed 43 people, including three

volcanologists. The highest of the Unzen peaks is Heisei-shinzan, at 4,875 ft (1,486 m).

## Sakurajima

**Location** Kyushu island, Japan

Prior to 1914, this composite volcano was an island, but enormous lava flows in an eruption of that year filled the main strait between the island and the mainland. Sakurajima is one of Japan's most active volcanoes,



▲ SANDSTONE COLUMNS IN THE TIANZI MOUNTAINS